New wrestling parent FAQ

Mat Rats and Valkyries families • Westminster Area Recreation Council

Follow your coach's current event instructions. The published first-year Pups clinic is practice only.

1 When should we arrive?

Check the team message for arrival, weigh-ins and meeting place. Arrive before wrestling starts and find the coach.

2 What if we are late or absent?

Notify your team contact promptly through the usual team channel. Ask what to do next.

3 What should we bring?

Bring uniform, wrestling shoes, headgear, water, snacks and spare clothes. Confirm mouthguard rules, especially with braces, and what the club supplies.

4 Do we need a membership?

Ask whether this event requires USA Wrestling membership or separate registration before buying. Spectator admission does not allow coaching.

5 How are opponents chosen?

Regular Mid Maryland Wrestling League pairings aim to consider age, weight and experience. Tournaments may differ. Ask the coach about pairing concerns before wrestling.

6 What are mat and bout numbers?

Mat means where; bout means which match. On deck usually means next; in the hole usually means after that. Recheck assignments.

7 What if our coach is missing?

Tell a team helper and staging or table staff promptly. Ask for help before the bout.

8 Can we leave after a loss?

Check with the coach before leaving. Your child may have more matches, even after a loss.

9 How long will it take?

Standard folkstyle matches have three periods; your coach confirms timing and overtime. Expect waiting between bouts.

10 How does scoring work?

Takedown 3; escape 1; reversal 2; near fall usually 2/3/4. A pin ends the match. See the handout for details.

11 Why did the referee stop them?

Whistles can signal restarts, safety concerns, penalties or a period ending. A whistle alone does not mean points.

12 Where should I watch?

Stay in spectator areas unless your child is wrestling or next. Approach matside only if the host permits. Return to the spectator area afterward.

13 What if the score looks wrong?

Let your coach handle scoring questions. Respect officials. Report urgent safety concerns to event staff immediately.

14 What if my child is upset?

Offer comfort and tell the coach. Allow time before discussing the match. Praise effort and learning.

15 What about illness or injury?

Report illness, injury or suspicious skin spots before contact; seek medical advice. Suspected concussion: stop sports, no same-day return, healthcare clearance before returning.

16 Should my child cut weight?

No. Keep meals and hydration normal. Do not restrict food or water or sweat off weight. Discuss weight changes with the coach.

Grindstone club information

grindstonewrestling.org

USA Wrestling parent encouragement

TheMat.com — Coaching From the Stands

Optional reading. USA Wrestling article: parent support, not youth match timing. Scoring and safety sources are in the handout and research notes.